MĪMĀṂSĀ — THEORY OF KNOWLEDGE IN THE SERVICE OF DUTY

INQUIRY INTO DUTY AND THE LINEAGE → INTRINSIC VALIDITY AND ITS RIVAL → THE SIX INSTRUMENTS, POSTULATION AND NON-COGNITION → ERROR AND SELF-AWARENESS → LANGUAGE, AUTHORLESS VEDA AND INJUNCTION → NO CREATOR, SELF AND THE GRADED VERDICT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the yellow final synthesis. Each card uses a structure chosen for its own content: derivation, ladder, matrix, chain, dialectic, gated filter, panel and verdict. The grey E card is optional enrichment only.

Generated for review; prior artifacts unchanged and the immutable Carvaka reference package is untouched. Approval is withheld until the user approves this generation.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

STAGE 00 THE PROJECT — INQUIRY INTO DUTY AND WHY EPISTEMOLOGY SERVES IT

- DHARMA-JIJÑĀSĀ — INQUIRY INTO DUTY
- CODANĀ-LAKṢAṆO'RTHO DHARMAḤ
- DUTY IS SUPERSENSIBLE
- VERBAL TESTIMONY IS THE ONLY COMPETENT INSTRUMENT
- REALISM ABOUT OBJECTS AND PLURAL SELVES
- BEGINNINGLESS MORAL ORDER

DUTY IS SUPERSENSIBLE — no perception, no sign, no trustworthy human speaker

THEREFORE VEDIC TESTIMONY ALONE — promoted from convenience to sole competent witness → THEREFORE REMOVE THE AUTHOR — no locus for error, deceit, partiality, forgetfulness → THEREFORE REMOVE THE CERTIFIER — validity intrinsic, invalidity extrinsic

WHAT THE SCHOOL IS

- Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā is inquiry into duty (dharma-jijñāsā), not speculative theology
- Duty is that good whose distinguishing mark is Vedic injunction (codanā)
- Epistemology is therefore inseparable from hermeneutics

WHY EACH DOCTRINE EXISTS

- Perception is disqualified; inference has no sign for duty
- Only śabda reaches it, so the text must bind with no author (apauruṣeyatva)
- And cognition must be trustworthy with no certifier (svataḥ-prāmāṇya)
- An act must pay with no paymaster: unseen potency (apūrva)

MINIMUM METAPHYSICS

- Real enduring objects; plurality of selves as knower, agent and enjoyer
- Objects real so knowledge is possible; injunction meaningful so obligation is
- Action leaves potency, so a future fruit is possible

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Every celebrated doctrine repairs a hole opened by one decision about the object of knowledge.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Mīmāṃsā is a scripture-defence that had to become a general epistemology, because an authorless text can borrow authority from nowhere outside cognition.

STAGE 01 TEXTUAL LINEAGE AND THE PŪRVA / UTTARA OWNERSHIP FIREWALL

- JAIMINI — MĪMĀṂSĀ-SŪTRA
- ŚABARA — ŚĀBARA-BHĀṢYA
- KUMĀRILA — ŚLOKAVĀRTTIKA
- PRABHĀKARA — BṚHATĪ
- ŚĀLIKANĀTHA — LATER PRĀBHĀKARA
- CHRONOLOGY DEBATED, OWNERSHIP NOT

JAIMINI — Mīmāṃsā-sūtra organises the inquiry into duty and Vedic interpretation → ŚABARA — Śābara-bhāṣya, the foundational surviving commentary → KUMĀRILA BHAṬṬA — Ślokavārttika and Tantravārttika establish the Bhāṭṭa line → PRABHĀKARA MIŚRA — Bṛhatī establishes the Prābhākara line, expounded by Śālikanātha

OWNED HERE

- Injunction · duty · authorless verbal authority · ritual interpretation
- Both sub-schools inherit the same base and divide on epistemology and semantics

OWNED BY VEDĀNTA

- Brahman-centred interpretation of the Upaniṣads; māyā; superimposition
- The earlier inquiry reads the Veda as a command, the later as a disclosure

SOURCE CONTROL

- Much called Jaimini's view is reached through Śabara's commentary
- Bhāṭṭa names Kumārila's school and is not Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Purva- and Uttara-Mīmāṃsā are two answers to what a scripture is for, and almost every quarrel between them follows from that one difference.

STAGE 02 ONE INSTINCT, SIX CONSEQUENCES — THE BHĀṬṬA / PRĀBHĀKARA GRID

- BHĀṬṬA ADMITS WHAT RESISTS REDUCTION
- PRĀBHĀKARA ECONOMISES
- SIX VERSUS FIVE INSTRUMENTS
- UNITY IN DIFFERENCE
- SIX OF FOURTEEN PYQS NAME A SUB-SCHOOL
- NEVER WRITE AN UNATTRIBUTED MĪMĀṂSĀ VIEW

ISSUE	BHĀṬṬA (KUMĀRILA)	PRĀBHĀKARA
Instruments	Six, including non-cognition	Five
Absence	Real abhāva with a counterpositive	Bare locus, unqualified
Error	Contrary apprehension (viparīta-khyāti)	Non-discrimination (akhyāti)
Cognition of cognition	Knownness (jñātatā), inferred	Threefold awareness (tripuṭī-saṃvit)
Sentence meaning	Abhihitānvaya: denote, then connect	Anvitābhidhāna: denote as connected
Motivation	Bhāvanā-vāda: the desired fruit	Niyoga-vāda: the command itself

SHARED FOUNDATION

- Vedic authority · realism · ritual efficacy through apūrva
- Intrinsic validity · irreducibility as the admission test

WHY IT MATTERS

- The sub-school label predicts the position on every other question
- Leanness is not superiority: economy that distorts the phenomenon is false economy

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Six paired differences follow from one methodological instinct applied to six separate cases.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Bhāṭṭa-Prābhākara dispute is not six quarrels but one, about whether to enlarge the inventory to fit the phenomenon or trim the phenomenon to fit the inventory.

STAGE 03 INTRINSIC VALIDITY — THE FOUR CELLS OF ORIGIN AND ASCERTAINMENT

- SVATAḤ-PRĀMĀṆYAVĀDA
- UTPATTI — ORIGIN
- JÑAPTI — ASCERTAINMENT
- DOṢA — DEFECT
- BĀDHAKA — DEFEATER
- DEFEASIBLE DEFAULT WARRANT, NOT INFALLIBILISM

	ORIGIN (UTPATTI)	ASCERTAINMENT (JÑAPTI)
VALIDITY	INTRINSIC — the same conditions generate the cognition and its validity	INTRINSIC — it presents itself as trustworthy, unaided
INVALIDITY	EXTRINSIC — needs a defect: bad light, distance, organ-damage, dream-state	EXTRINSIC — needs a defeater: contradiction, failure, correction

THE STATEMENT

- A cognition is valid by its own occurrence under normal causal conditions
- It carries prima facie validity unless and until defeated

THE PRESUPPOSITION

- Realism: cognitions aim at real objects and normal causes tend toward truth
- Without it the doctrine collapses into subjectivist self-certification

THE DECIDING DISTINCTION

- Intrinsic validity is not incorrigibility; validity is not certainty
- Extrinsic invalidity does not make error impossible

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The doctrine is a claim about four cells, and answers that state only the validity row cannot explain error.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Intrinsic validity is a refusal to let scepticism set the terms, because doubt is parasitic on a trust that must already be in place before doubt can be raised.

STAGE 04 THE ANTI-REGRESS ARGUMENT AND THE STRUCTURE OF DEFAULT TRUST

- ANAVASTHĀ — INFINITE REGRESS
- EPISTEMIC ECONOMY
- BURDEN ON THE CHALLENGER
- NO FIRST ACTION WITHOUT TRUST
- POT ON THE FLOOR — THE ORDINARY CASE

COGNITION DISCLOSES AN OBJECT → EXTERNAL VALIDATION WOULD REGRESS WITHOUT END → SOME COGNITION MUST BE VALID UNAIDED → MOST ECONOMICALLY, EACH IS PRIMA FACIE VALID → BURDEN SHIFTS TO THE CHALLENGER

THE REGRESS HALF

- Cognition is meant to disclose an object
- If each needed another to validate it, the validator needs a validator
- To stop the regress some cognition must be valid unaided; most economically, each

THE PRACTICE HALF

- We live by trusting cognitions unless a defeating condition appears
- If confirmation preceded every cognition, no first action could be launched
- Crossing a road, reading a page, obeying an instruction all presuppose trust

STANDING OBJECTIONS

- Error should be impossible — reply: error needs an extrinsic defect
- This licenses gullibility — reply: the thesis is defeasible and invites correction
- Why call it valid before checking — reply: checking begins from a trusted cognition

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nothing in the doctrine claims that cognition cannot be wrong; it claims only that being wrong is the condition that has to be earned.

STAGE 05 THE EXTRINSIC RIVAL AND THE DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- PARATAḤ-PRĀMĀṆYAVĀDA
- PRAVṚTTI-SĀMARTHYA
- SAṂVĀDI-PRATYAKṢA
- VALIDITY VERSUS ASCERTAINMENT
- DREAM AND MIRAGE
- APPEARANCE OF NORMALCY IS NOT NORMALCY

NYĀYA'S TWO ROUTES

- Successful practical activity certifies the cognition after the fact
- A later confirming perception agrees with the earlier cognition

MĪMĀṂSĀ'S THREE COUNTERS

- Acting on a cognition already presupposes trusting it
- A validating cognition would itself need validation: the regress returns
- Success can confirm or disclose validity; it cannot generate it

THE DREAM OBJECTION ANSWERED

- Dream: exhaustion, sleep-state, internal disturbance are extrinsic defects
- Mirage: heated air and optical distortion are extrinsic defects
- Residual pressure: how is warranted default trust distinguished from credulity?

MECHANISM / VERDICT — If validity and the ascertainment of validity are the same thing Nyāya wins, and if they come apart Mīmāṃsā wins.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya's test measures our knowledge that a cognition was valid, not the validity it already possessed, so confirmation is evidence of truth rather than its manufacture.

STAGE 06 FOUR SCHOOLS PLACED ON VALIDITY AND INVALIDITY

- MĪMĀṂSĀ I / E
- NYĀYA E / E
- SĀṂKHYA I / I
- BUDDHIST E / I
- ILLUSION DOES NOT ANNOUNCE ITSELF
- SURVEY PRESENTATION, NOT ADJUDICATION

SCHOOL	VALIDITY	INVALIDITY	RELATION
Mīmāṃsā	Intrinsic	Extrinsic	The position under study
Nyāya	Extrinsic	Extrinsic	The chief rival
Sāṃkhya	Intrinsic	Intrinsic	Ally that goes too far
Buddhist	Extrinsic	Intrinsic	The exact mirror-image

WHERE MĪMĀṂSĀ AGREES

- With Sāṃkhya on the intrinsic side of validity
- With no one on making invalidity intrinsic

THE DECISIVE COUNTER

- If falsity were intrinsic, illusion would reveal itself as illusion at once
- Illusion deceives precisely because it does not, so the asymmetry is rejected

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Mīmāṃsā is the only school in the strip that makes truth free and falsehood expensive, and that asymmetry is the whole of its anti-sceptical strategy.

STAGE 07 THE INSTRUMENT LIST AND THE ADMISSION RULE

- IRREDUCIBILITY IS THE ADMISSION TEST
- BHĀṬṬA SIX · PRĀBHĀKARA FIVE
- ARTHĀPATTI AND ANUPALABDHI
- PRAMĀṆA · PRAMĀ · PRAVṚTTI-SĀMARTHYA
- ANADHIGATATVA EXCLUDES MEMORY
- STRUCTURES, NOT FACULTIES

SCHOOL	PERCEPTION	INFERENCE	COMPARISON	TESTIMONY	POSTULATION	NON-COGNITION	TOTAL
Sāṃkhya	yes	yes	-	yes	-	-	3
Nyāya	yes	yes	yes	yes	-	-	4
Prābhākara	yes	yes	yes	yes	yes	-	5
Bhāṭṭa	yes	yes	yes	yes	yes	yes	6

THE RULE

- Admit a new instrument only where reduction fails without remainder or circularity
- Instruments are individuated by the manner of generation, not by topic

WHY TWO EXTRA SEATS

- Postulation resolves explanatory tension among known facts
- Absence-cognition discloses what is not there under fit conditions
- Neither arises through signhood nor through positive direct perception

THE SAME RULE EXCLUDES

- Memory reproduces already-cognised content and fails novelty
- A school inflating its list would not have exercised this restraint

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The longer list is the product of a rule rather than of appetite, since the same rule also excludes memory.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Mīmāṃsā's longer list is not epistemic generosity but epistemic honesty, refusing to call a cognition inference merely because inference is already on the list.

STAGE 08 THE FOUR SHARED INSTRUMENTS AND THEIR MĪMĀṂSĀ TUNING

- NIRVIKALPAKA THEN SAVIKALPAKA
- INTERPRETS, DOES NOT FALSIFY
- ANTI-REDUCTIONISM ABOUT ANUMĀNA
- GAVAYA SIMILARITY-COGNITION
- PAURUṢEYA VERSUS APAURUṢEYA
- DO NOT IMPORT THE NYĀYA UPAMĀNA

PERCEPTION AND INFERENCE

- Indeterminate perception registers presence before classification
- Determinate perception grasps class, quality, action and name: a white moving cow
- Smoke seen with concomitance known yields fire: inference is fully accepted

COMPARISON, STATED CORRECTLY

- A remembered cow is known to be similar to this perceived wild ox (gavaya)
- Not perception, not memory, not inference; no universal concomitance is used
- Nyāya instead learns the word-object relation from prior testimony

TESTIMONY, TWO CUTS

- By source: personal testimony inherits speaker-defect; Vedic testimony is impersonal
- By function: fact-stating (siddhārtha) and action-enjoining (vidhāyaka)
- Testimony is not a fallback here; for duty it is the only competent instrument

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each shared instrument is quietly re-tuned so that realism and the defence of Vedic authority both survive.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Mīmāṃsā keeps every instrument its rivals keep and re-tunes each one, so that classification does not become falsification and testimony is no longer a convenience.

STAGE 09 MEMORY EXCLUDED — THE NOVELTY CONDITION AND ITS CONVERGENCE

- SMṚTI IS NOT A PRAMĀṆA
- ANADHIGATATVA — NOVELTY
- SAṂSKĀRA — LATENT IMPRESSION
- PRĀBHĀKARA AND NYĀYA AGREE
- TRUE AND USEFUL IS NOT ENOUGH

DOES IT OPERATE AS A SOURCE? YES → DOES IT DISCLOSE AN OBJECT? YES → DOES IT DISCLOSE FRESHLY? NO — IT RE-PRESENTS → THEREFORE NOT AN INSTRUMENT, THOUGH OFTEN TRUE

THE FIVE STEPS

- An instrument must generate a new cognition of an object
- Memory depends on an earlier cognition and its latent impression
- It reproduces old content and reveals no new object as presently known

WHAT IT DOES NOT SAY

- Memory may be true, useful and successfully action-guiding
- The ground is not unreliability but the absence of fresh disclosure
- Seeing a temple now is perception; recalling yesterday's visit is not

WHERE MEMORY STILL WORKS

- Comparison uses a remembered cow
- Prābhākara's error-theory uses a remembered silver
- Bhāṭṭa sentence-comprehension uses memory of the ordered series of phonemes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Memory is excluded not because it is unreliable but because it is unoriginal, and it can be perfectly true while still failing the one condition that matters.

STAGE 10 POSTULATION — FROM EXPLANATORY TENSION TO A RECONCILING POSTULATE

- ARTHĀPATTI
- ANUPAPATTI — INCOMPATIBILITY
- STOUT DEVADATTA
- MINIMALLY RECONCILING POSTULATE
- DṚṢṬĀRTHĀPATTI AND ŚRUTĀRTHĀPATTI
- ACCEPTED BY BOTH SUB-SCHOOLS

DEVADATTA IS STOUT — PERCEPTION → HE DOES NOT EAT BY DAY — TESTIMONY OR REPEATED OBSERVATION → STOUTNESS IS INCOMPATIBLE WITH TOTAL ABSENCE OF NOURISHMENT → HE EATS AT NIGHT — NEITHER PERCEIVED HERE NOR REMEMBERED

THE STRUCTURE

- A and B are known; they cannot stand together unless C is admitted
- Therefore C is postulated, and the necessity is explanatory reconciliation

TWO FORMS

- From perceived facts: the Devadatta case
- From heard words: ellipsis and contextual completion of an utterance
- Both are necessity, never tentative hypothesis

WHY IT IS NOT A GUESS

- The output is the least addition that makes the facts coherent
- Only postulations required by an established incompatibility qualify
- It also establishes unseen potency and supplies the form of the authorlessness argument

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Postulation is knowledge produced by the pressure of coherence rather than by the guidance of a sign, because nothing points to the night-eating and nothing else lets the known facts stand.

STAGE 11 POSTULATION IS NOT INFERENCE — THREE ARGUMENTS AND THE CIRCULARITY REPLY

- NO INDEPENDENT VYĀPTI
- REVERSED DIRECTION OF REASONING
- NO PAKṢA, HETU, SĀDHYA
- THE REDUCTION IS CIRCULAR
- THE 2024 CANDIDATE CASE
- STRONGER THAN BEST EXPLANATION

THE THREE ARGUMENTS

- Inference needs a concomitance known beforehand; no rule about stout day-fasters exists
- Inference runs sign to signified; postulation runs tension to reconciling postulate
- There is no reason sitting in a subject from which a probandum is derived

NYĀYA'S REDUCTION ANSWERED

- Nyāya offers fatness as reason, eating as probandum, whoever is fat eats as concomitance
- That concomitance is not independently known; claiming it concedes the disputed move
- The reduction consumes its own conclusion

THE APPLIED CASE

- The candidate tops the examination yet is never seen studying by day
- Success is incompatible with no preparation, so unobserved preparation is posited
- Nyāya's inferential framing slides in a concomitance far too quickly

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The classical claim is stronger than inference to the best explanation, because the postulate is required and not merely preferred.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya's reduction fails at its first step, since the very concomitance it needs was itself learned by the tension-driven move it is trying to abolish.

STAGE 12 NON-COGNITION AND THE FITNESS FILTER THAT MAKES IT RESPECTABLE

- ANUPALABDHI — BHĀṬṬA ONLY
- YOGYĀNUPALABDHI
- PERCEPTIBLE IN KIND
- SUITABLE LOCUS, WORKING ORGAN
- PROPER LIGHT, DISTANCE, ATTENTION
- NOT MERE NON-NOTICING

NON-APPREHENSION OF WHAT WOULD BE APPREHENDED IF PRESENT

FITNESS SATISFIED — DETERMINATE KNOWLEDGE OF ABSENCE → FITNESS FAILS — MERE NON-NOTICING AND NO KNOWLEDGE AT ALL

THE SEVEN STEPS

- We know absences, and the cognition is definite and action-guiding
- Not perception, which gives positive content; not inference, which needs a sign
- Not memory, comparison or testimony; therefore an independent source is needed

FIT AND UNFIT CASES

- No pot on this bare, well-lit table before the eyes — knowledge
- No atoms here — the object is not perceptible in kind, so the filter fails
- Keys unseen on a cluttered desk in poor light — careless overlooking

BOTH REDUCTIONS REFUSED

- Perceiving the empty table is not yet cognising that the pot is absent
- Treating not-seeing as a sign presupposes the very force fitness supplies

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kumārila does not claim that failing to see teaches anything, but that it teaches something exactly when failing to see is guaranteed to be informative.

STAGE 13 ABSENCE — ONTOLOGY AND THE THREE-WAY DISPUTE

- ABHĀVA IS REAL FOR BHĀṬṬA
- PRATIYOGIN — COUNTERPOSITIVE
- BARE LOCUS, UNQUALIFIED
- POT-ABSENCE-ON-THE-FLOOR
- NYĀYA DENIES THE INSTRUMENT, NOT ABHĀVA
- 2021, 2023 AND 2025 ALL LIVE HERE

SCHOOL	WHAT IS KNOWN	SEPARATE INSTRUMENT?
Bhāṭṭa	A real absence structured by its counterpositive	Yes — anupalabdhi
Prābhākara	The locus as unqualified by the absent object	No — bare-locus perception
Nyāya	Absence itself, directly perceived	No — abhāva is a perceptual object

THE INTERNAL DEBATE

- Bhāṭṭa: absence is real and known by an independent instrument
- Prābhākara: the locus is perceived as unqualified; no instrument is needed
- Kumārila's counter: economy that flattens a negative judgement is false economy

THE GRADED VERDICT

- Bhāṭṭa is the most faithful phenomenologist and carries the heaviest ontology
- Prābhākara is the more economical metaphysician; Nyāya the most perceptually direct

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Nyāya and Prābhākara converge against Bhāṭṭa on independence while diverging entirely in their reasons.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The 2025 question is decided inside Mīmāṃsā and not against Nyāya, because the real quarrel is whether a negative judgement can be flattened into a positive perception.

STAGE 14 FOUR THEORIES OF ERROR, AND TWO DEFENCES OF ONE THESIS

- SHELL-SILVER IS THE SHARED DATUM
- AKHYĀTI IS NON-APPREHENSION OF DIFFERENCE
- VIPARĪTA-KHYĀTI MISIDENTIFIES THIS OBJECT
- ANYATHĀ-KHYĀTI MISPLACES ANOTHER
- ANIRVACANĪYA-KHYĀTI
- NEVER MERGE BHĀṬṬA WITH NYĀYA

THEORY	SCHOOL	EXPLANATION	STATUS OF THE SILVER
Akhyāti / vivekākhyāti	Prābhākara	Two valid cognitions, difference unapprehended	No false silver at all
Viparīta-khyāti	Bhāṭṭa	The shell is positively miscognised as silver	A really wrong identification
Anyathā-khyāti	Nyāya	Real silver known elsewhere is presented here	Real but displaced
Anirvacanīya-khyāti	Advaita	An indescribable appearance, later sublated	Neither real nor unreal

PRĀBHĀKARA'S STRATEGY

- Valid perception of this shining thing, valid memory of silver, difference unapprehended
- No separate false cognition is posited, so every constituent cognition stays valid
- Cost: the assertive force of this is silver rests on a failure of discrimination

BHĀṬṬA'S STRATEGY

- Defect causes one erroneous cognition, corrected on approaching the shell
- Falsity is quarantined in abnormal conditions and known extrinsically
- Cost: a false cognition is admitted into a system built on default truth

THE 2022 ANSWER

- Same thesis, two defence strategies: constituents versus the governing principle
- The in spite of clause is the question, not the scene-setting

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Prabhākara saves intrinsic validity by admitting no false cognition anywhere and Kumārila by admitting one and quarantining it, so the quarrel is about the price of the same trust.

STAGE 15 KNOWING THAT ONE KNOWS — THREE STOPPING-POINTS FOR ONE REGRESS

- TRIPUṬĪ-SAṂVIT — NO GAP
- JÑĀTATĀ — INFERENTIAL GAP
- ANUVYAVASĀYA — REFLECTIVE GAP
- LAMP AND PAINTER
- SVAPRAKĀŚA IS NOT SVATAḤ-PRĀMĀṆYA
- BHĀṬṬA IS THE 2018 COUNTEREXAMPLE

PRĀBHĀKARA

- One act discloses knower, known and knowing together, so no second cognition is needed
- A lamp reveals itself while revealing the room; reflection is later articulation
- The three are disclosed together, not ontologically collapsed

BHĀṬṬA

- The object acquires knownness, from which the cognition is inferred
- A painter paints objects but not himself; occurrence is read off what is left behind
- I know first and I know that I know afterwards

NYĀYA AND THE ENTAILMENT QUESTION

- A distinct second-order cognition takes the first as its object: I know the pot
- Nyāya accepts neither self-luminosity nor intrinsic validity
- Kumārila combines intrinsic validity with denial of self-luminosity

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Manifestation and truth-entitlement are different questions, so neither doctrine follows from the other by definition.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A single actual case of intrinsic validity without self-luminosity refutes the claim of necessity, and Kumārila supplies it from inside Mīmāṃsā itself.

STAGE 16 SENTENCE-UNITY, THE TWO SEMANTICS, AND WHAT WORDS DENOTE

- EKAVĀKYATĀ
- ĀKĀṄKṢĀ · YOGYATĀ · SANNIDHI
- TĀTPARYA WITHOUT AN AUTHOR
- ABHIHITĀNVAYA IS BHĀṬṬA
- ANVITĀBHIDHĀNA IS PRĀBHĀKARA
- JĀTI PRIMARY, APOHA REFUSED
- SPHOṬA REJECTED BY BOTH

SHARED CONDITIONS

- Expectancy: Bring leaves an open expectation of what is to be brought
- Fitness: sprinkle with fire is unfit in ordinary usage
- Proximity: words separated by unrelated discourse fail to cohere
- Purport is added by Naiyāyikas but cannot rest on intention in an authorless Veda

THE TWO ROUTES

- Bhāṭṭa: each word denotes through abhidhā, then meanings connect — word is primary
- Prābhākara: words denote only as already connected — the sentence is primary
- Evidence: a child learns bring the cow from the whole commanded event
- Verdict: stable lexical meaning against contextual action-guidance

UNIVERSALS AND THE RIVALS

- Words primarily denote the universal; the individual is reached through it
- Nyāya reverses the priority; both reach both, so the dispute is priority not coverage
- Exclusion cannot ground stable positive recognition and repeatable application
- Eternal phonemes with ordered manifestation make an indivisible sound-burst unnecessary

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the Veda has no speaker, purport must be relocated into textual force and subordination to injunction.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Bhāṭṭa hears words that have been joined and the Prābhākara hears a sentence that has been analysed, and the dispute is over which report describes the original event.

STAGE 17 AUTHORLESS VEDA, INJUNCTION, UNSEEN POTENCY AND NO CREATOR

- APAURUṢEYATVA
- ŚABDA-NITYATVA AND AUTPATTIKA
- MANIFESTED, NOT PRODUCED
- ŚĀBDĪ IMPELS, ĀRTHĪ PRODUCES
- NIYOGA BINDS DIRECTLY
- APŪRVA BY ARTHĀPATTI
- REDUNDANT OR MORALLY PROBLEMATIC

REMOVE THE AUTHOR AND THE DEFECT-LOCUS GOES WITH HIM

IMPERATIVE FORCE MOVES INTO THE VERBAL FORM ITSELF → THE PERISHING ACT LEAVES AN UNSEEN POTENCY → THEREFORE NO CREATOR AND NO DISPENSER OF FRUITS IS REQUIRED

THE TEXT THAT NEEDS NO AUTHOR

- No author is remembered, though such an author would have been
- The word-meaning relation is natural, and word-units are manifested by utterance
- Kaṭha and Kauṣītaki name schools and transmitters, never composers
- Authority is restricted to duty, where no rival instrument can supply a defeater

THE COMMAND THAT NEEDS NO COMMANDER

- Imperative force sits in the injunctive verbal form itself
- Bhāṭṭa: verbal force yields the impulse, objective force yields the fruit
- Prābhākara: the directly apprehended to-be-done binds the qualified agent
- Three factors ask what is to be brought about, by what means, and how (itikartavyatā)

THE FRUIT THAT NEEDS NO PAYMASTER

- The act perishes but its unseen potency persists until the fruit matures
- The potency is postulated, not asserted, by explanatory necessity
- A God distributing by karma is redundant; distributing otherwise, unjust
- Ritual deities are retained as mantra-denoted recipients, not as causes

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The atheism is not a rebellion against the scripture but the final step of the argument that defends it.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Every rival grounds a scripture by praising somebody and Mīmāṃsā grounds it by finding nobody, wagering that an absent author is safer than a perfect one.

STAGE 18 FINAL SYNTHESIS — SELF, LIBERATION, COMPARISONS AND THE GRADED VERDICT

- PLURAL ENDURING SELVES
- AGENT MUST EQUAL ENJOYER
- LIBERATION IS LATE AND MODEST
- FIVE INTER-SCHOOL FRONTS
- 14 PRIMARY-OWNED PYQ PARTS
- QUALIFIED VERDICT, NEVER A KNOCKOUT

10 MARKS — STRONGEST AS INTRINSIC VALIDITY AND VEDIC TESTIMONY, STATED AS DEFEASIBLE → 15 MARKS — ORIGINAL IN LINKING EPISTEMOLOGY, HERMENEUTICS AND DUTY → 20 MARKS — A COHERENT IMPERSONAL FOUNDATION, LEFT CONTESTED BY ITS RIVALS

SELF AND LIBERATION

- The self is knower, agent and enjoyer, and there are many eternal selves
- Cognition is episodic, not the self's uninterrupted manifest essence
- Release is the end of fresh merit and demerit and of karmic embodiment
- Neither Advaita's Brahman-identity nor Nyāya's creator may be imported

STRENGTHS AND WEAKNESSES

- Strong: testimony, interpretation, default entitlement, non-theistic normativity
- Weak: eternality of the word, unverifiable potency, purport without intention
- Contested: circularity, the status of the atheism, the placement of liberation

THE ANSWER SPINE

- Name the sub-school before stating any doctrine
- English concept first, accurate IAST immediately after
- Give the canonical example, then the rival, then the objection and reply
- Close with a qualified verdict at 10, 15 or 20 marks

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The school should be evaluated as a philosophy of duty and testimony rather than judged by a soteriological standard it never set itself.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Mīmāṃsā's self is a bookkeeping necessity before it is a metaphysical thesis, because someone must still be present when the promised fruit finally arrives.

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

- OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH
- APŪRVA AS A NON-THEISTIC BRIDGE
- INJUNCTION-CENTRED LANGUAGE
- DEFAULT TRUST AS GENERAL EPISTEMOLOGY
- ONE MOVE PER ANSWER, TWO AT MOST

OPTIONAL MODULE 1

- Stronger metaphysical reading of unseen potency against a restrained reading
- Objection: it looks like a placeholder. Reply: a divine distributor costs more

OPTIONAL MODULE 2

- Is the Veda authoritative because it reports truths or because it enjoins?
- Objection: this narrows scripture to command. Reply: the project is duty, not theology

OPTIONAL MODULE 3

- Narrow ritualist reading against a broad epistemic-conservatism reading
- Objection: default trust makes error hard to explain. Reply: error is parasitic

OPTIONAL STATUS — This enrichment is unnecessary for a competent core answer and never repairs missing core content.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels